1987

January: The Chinese respond with a build-up on their side of the border. Tension runs high but does not lead to war.

20 February: Arunachal Pradesh and Mizoram become Indian states.

27 December: An anti-Chinese demonstration is held in Lhasa. Protesters set fire to a police station and the police open fire on the crowd.

1988

11–13 May: India carries out a series of underground nuclear tests.

August: A nation-wide uprising breaks out against the dictatorship in Myanmar. India supports the pro-democracy forces. China stays close to the government in Yangon.

10 December: Further anti-Chinese riots in Lhasa. Several people are killed.

19–23 December: Indian Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi visits China.

1989

March–April: The rank-and-file of the insurgent Communist Party of Burma mutinies against the party's old, Maoist leadership and drives them into exile in China. China supports the mutiny and provides the new United Wa State Army with state-of-the art weaponry at the same time as it maintains cordial relations with Myanmar's military government.

5–6 March: Chinese police attack pro-independence protesters in Tibet. At least 469 people, including 82 Buddhist monks, are killed and 721 are injured, according to an independent Chinese journalist.

1990

September: Clashes occur between ethnic Nepalese and the Royal Bhutan Army in southern Bhutan. The violence escalates, prompting approximately 100,000 ethnic Nepalese to flee. Most of them end up in refugee camps in south-eastern Nepal.

1991

December: Chinese Premier Li Peng visits India, bilateral relations begin to thaw.